

We also need to make a few changes in *alien_invasion.py* to create an instance of `GameStats`. First, we'll update the import statements at the top of the file:

```
alien_invasion.py import sys
                  from time import sleep

                  import pygame

                  from settings import Settings
                  from game_stats import GameStats
                  from ship import Ship
                  --snip--
```

We import the `sleep()` function from the `time` module in the Python standard library, so we can pause the game for a moment when the ship is hit. We also import `GameStats`.

We'll create an instance of `GameStats` in `__init__()`:

```
alien_invasion.py def __init__(self):
                  --snip--
                  self.screen = pygame.display.set_mode(
                      (self.settings.screen_width, self.settings.screen_height))
                  pygame.display.set_caption("Alien Invasion")

                  # Create an instance to store game statistics.
                  self.stats = GameStats(self)

                  self.ship = Ship(self)
                  --snip--
```

We make the instance after creating the game window but before defining other game elements, such as the ship.

When an alien hits the ship, we'll subtract 1 from the number of ships left, destroy all existing aliens and bullets, create a new fleet, and reposition the ship in the middle of the screen. We'll also pause the game for a moment so the player can notice the collision and regroup before a new fleet appears.

Let's put most of this code in a new method called `_ship_hit()`. We'll call this method from `_update_aliens()` when an alien hits the ship:

```
alien
_invasion.py def _ship_hit(self):
              """Respond to the ship being hit by an alien."""
              # Decrement ships left.
              ❶ self.stats.ships_left -= 1

              # Get rid of any remaining bullets and aliens.
              ❷ self.bullets.empty()
              self.aliens.empty()

              # Create a new fleet and center the ship.
              ❸ self._create_fleet()
              self.ship.center_ship()
```
